
Urgent concern regarding data center plans in Callaway county

From Will Shryock <willjshryock@gmail.com>

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To Curt Warfield <cwarfield@callawaycounty.org>; Christopher Scott <cscott@callawaycounty.org>; Gary Jungermann <GJungermann@Callawaycounty.org>

Dear Commissioners,

I and many of my family members are residents of Callaway county, and I am writing to formally express my opposition to the proposed data center project in our County, unless proper protections for the community are in place.

While I support economic development, I believe AI data centers and similar business projects present significant risks to our community that must be properly mitigated.

My concerns include:

1. Environmental Impact: The potential for excessive water consumption and noise pollution from cooling systems and generators.
2. Grid Reliability: The immense energy demands could cause utility rates to rise for local residents.
3. Land Use: This project does not align with the rural/residential character of our area, disrupting agricultural land and local wildlife.

While these facilities provide tax revenue, they are intense industrial users that require careful regulation to be "good neighbors". At a minimum, please consider the following when evaluating new proposals:

- * Mandating noise mitigation: Restricting chiller operations to meet noise limits at property lines.
- * Environmental Protection: Prohibiting projects in floodplains or areas with high water tables, and regulating water and electric usage such that it does not impact the availability or costs of these basic utilities for the citizens of the surrounding communities.
- * Thermal Pollution Study: Evaluating the impact of "heat domes" on surrounding agriculture.

I urge the commission to institute a moratorium to conduct a comprehensive impact study before approving any such project.

Sincerely,
Will Shryock
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